relating to the structures and functions of the organs of the United Nations were worked out amidst several objections, adjustments and demands. At the Yalta Conference of 11 February 1945, Roosevelt, Churchill and Stalin declared their resolve to establish “a general international organization to maintain peace and security”. Finally, the largest conference for framing of the UN Charter was held in San Francisco from 25 April to 26 June 1945 and it was attended by 280 delegates from 50 invitee nations. After much scrutinization and review of the Dumbarton Oaks proposals and with important changes, finally, the San Francisco Conference ended with the signing of the Charter on 26 June 1945. After the ratification of the Charter by the five permanent members (the P–5) of the Security Council and the majority of the signatories, the Charter came into force with effect from 24 October 1945. October 24 has, therefore, been declared as the United Nations Day. This was the beginning of the world organization and the First General Assembly opened in the Central Hall, Westminster on 10 January 1946, with representatives from 51 nations. The Security Council met for the first time in London on 17 January 1946. Trygve Lie of Norway became the first Secretary-General on 1 February 1946.

Purposes and Principles of the UN

The Charter of the United Nations begins with a Preamble which outlines the purposes or objectives of this international organization. The vision of a world based on the ideals of peace, justice, truth and fraternity is contained in the Preamble. It reads as follows:

“We the peoples of the United Nations determined, to save succeeding generations from the scourge of war, which twice in our lifetime has brought untold sorrow to mankind, and to reaffirm faith in fundamental human rights, in the dignity and worth of the human person, in the equal rights of men and women and of nations large and small, and to establish conditions under which justice and respect for the obligations arising from treaties and other sources of international law can be maintained, and to promote social progress and better standards of life in larger freedom”.

The Preamble bears testimony to the devastating and nerve-wracking experiences of the First World War and simultaneous urge